

# Generator safety

## **ACTION CHECKLIST**

**Operate a portable generator outdoors at least 20 feet from doors, windows and vents, with exhaust directed away from buildings. Never run it in a home, garage or enclosed space. Use working CO alarms and never connect a generator to a wall outlet.**

### **[ ] Choose outdoor placement**

Keep the generator away from occupied buildings and openings, including neighbors.

### **[ ] Connect safely**

Use rated cords as instructed; a building connection requires a professionally installed transfer switch.

### **[ ] Refuel safely**

Shut down and let it cool before refueling. Store fuel safely outside living areas.

### **[ ] Check CO alarms**

If an alarm sounds or symptoms occur, leave for fresh air and call emergency services.

## **WATCH FOR**

An open garage door does not make indoor generator operation safe.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/generator-safety/>

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